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Macro & Market Overview

Tariff-Driven Volatility

In early April 2026, e-commerce stocks faced strong selling pressure due to worsening trade conditions in the United States. Andy Jassy, CEO of Amazon.com, Inc., had already warned at the World Economic Forum in Davos in January 2026 that tariff-related costs were slowly increasing product prices. This happened because earlier low-cost inventory held by third-party sellers had started to run out (*Capital.com*, n.d.).

Another important factor was the removal of the de minimis tariff exemption. Previously, goods valued under \$800 could enter the US without import duties. When this rule was removed, it had a strong negative impact on companies that depend on low-value international shipments (*Fortune*, n.d.).

Platforms like Etsy, Inc. and eBay Inc. were affected the most because many of their sellers rely on imported materials and products. In February 2026, a US Supreme Court decision removed certain tariffs, which caused Etsy's stock to increase by about 8% in one day. However, this gain did not last long. A new executive order quickly reintroduced a 10% tariff, which caused the stock to fall again (Telle, 2026).

The April 29 Earnings Catalyst

April 29, 2026 was a very important day for the technology sector because several major companies released their quarterly earnings on the same day. These included

Amazon.com, Inc., Microsoft, Meta Platforms, Alphabet Inc., eBay Inc., and Etsy, Inc..

This led to a strong movement in the NASDAQ Composite, which increased by about 14% during April, marking its best monthly performance since April 2020 (*CNBC*, 2026)

In cloud computing, Microsoft Azure reported revenue growth of 40% year-on-year, while Google Cloud grew by 63% to reach \$20 billion. Both results were higher than expected and showed strong demand for AI-related infrastructure (SEC Filings, 2026).

For the e-commerce sector, these results showed that consumer spending was still strong even with economic challenges. Companies that used advanced technology such as AI tools and focused on specific product categories performed better than others.

At the same time, eBay Inc. has strengthened its position in the third-party marketplace by focusing on special categories such as collectibles and second-hand fashion. It has an estimated \$39 billion in platform GMV and avoids direct competition in fast-moving new product markets (*Marketplace Pulse*, 2026).

Amazon.Inc

Company Overview

Amazon.com, Inc. is one of the largest companies in the world, operating in both e-commerce and cloud computing. The company runs its business through three main segments: North America Retail, International Retail, and Amazon Web Services (AWS). Among these, AWS is the most important profit driver because it generates higher margins compared to retail operations (*Yahoo*, n.d.).

In addition, Amazon has a rapidly growing advertising business, which is becoming another strong source of income. The company also benefits from its advanced logistics network, Alexa AI platform, and Amazon Prime membership system. These factors create strong competitive advantages and make it difficult for competitors to match Amazon's scale and efficiency.

Price Performance and Fluctuation Analysis

Amazon's stock showed strong performance in April 2026, rising by around 27% during the month. This made it one of the best-performing major technology stocks in 2026 so far, with a year-to-date gain of about 14.4% by April 24 (*Motley Fool*, n.d.).

The stock reached a new all-time high of \$263.99 on April 24, 2026, with a 52-week range between \$178.85 and \$277.12 (*Mexc*, n.d.).

Amazon Candlestick Chart



Key Drivers of Price Movements

Early April Decline:

At the beginning of April, Amazon's share price dropped to around \$202–\$210. This decline was mainly due to concerns about US–China trade tensions, which affected the overall market. However, Amazon recovered quickly because its diversified business model, especially AWS, provided stability compared to other retail-focused companies (*Capital.com*, n.d.).

Mid-to-Late April Recovery:

After the initial drop, the stock showed a strong upward trend.

- **Q1 2026 Earnings:**
Amazon reported better-than-expected results on April 29. Earnings per share were \$2.78 compared to the expected \$1.64, while revenue reached \$181.5 billion, showing a 17% increase year-on-year. AWS revenue grew by 28% to \$37.6 billion, marking its fastest growth in several quarters. The North America segment also improved, with margins increasing to 9.0% (*CNBC*, 2026).
- **Advertising Growth:**
Amazon's advertising business continued to expand, with revenue

increasing by about 24% year-on-year. This high-margin segment is becoming more important for the company's overall profitability (Khusuma, 2026).

- **Analyst Upgrades:**

Following the strong earnings report, several analysts increased their price targets. The average target price is around \$289, suggesting some potential upside from current levels (Mexc, n.d.).



Trading volume also increased significantly around April 29–30, indicating strong investor interest after the earnings announcement. This suggests that institutional investors played a key role in the price movement.

Five-Year Historical Context



Over the past five years, Amazon's stock has shown clear cycles of growth and decline. The stock reached a peak in 2021, followed

by a sharp decline of about 55% during 2022. Since then, Amazon has gradually recovered, supported by improvements in AWS performance and increased focus on artificial intelligence.

By late 2024, the stock had returned to its previous high levels and continued to rise, reaching new record highs in early 2026 (Yahoo, n.d.).

LSTM Forecast (May 1–14, 2026)

Amazon (AMZN) — May 2026 Price Forecast



The LSTM model predicts a short-term decline in Amazon's stock price. According to the forecast, the price may decrease from around \$259.25 on May 1 to approximately \$244.16 by May 14. This represents a potential drop of about 5.8% over two weeks. Full day-by-day predictions are presented in the Consolidated Forecast section.

This expected decline can be explained by several factors. First, the stock experienced a strong rally in April, and such rapid increases are often followed by a period of consolidation. Second, Amazon's free cash flow decreased significantly in Q1 2026 due to high capital expenditure, which reached over \$40 billion. This level of spending may raise concerns among investors.

In addition, uncertainty related to tariffs remains a risk. Amazon’s CEO, Andy Jassy, mentioned that higher costs could eventually be passed on to customers, which may affect future demand.

Investment Recommendation

Recommendation: SELL

Although Amazon’s financial performance in Q1 2026 was very strong, the stock has already increased significantly in April. Much of the positive news appears to be reflected in the current price.

There are several short-term risks to consider. Amazon is investing heavily in infrastructure, with capital expenditure expected to remain high throughout 2026. This has already reduced free cash flow in the recent quarter. In addition, insider selling activity suggests that some executives may consider the current price level relatively high (Gurufocus, n.d.).

Based on the LSTM forecast and current market conditions, a short-term price correction is likely. Investors may consider reducing their positions or using risk management strategies such as stop-loss orders around the \$250–\$255 range. A better opportunity to buy may appear if the price falls closer to \$240–\$245.

Overall, while Amazon remains a strong company in the long run, a short-term decline or consolidation phase is expected in May 2026.

Competitor Analysis

Amazon operates in a highly competitive environment across both retail and cloud computing.

In the retail sector, its main competitor is Walmart, which reported revenue of over \$700 billion and continues to expand its online marketplace (Aura, 2026).

In cloud computing, Amazon faces strong competition from Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud (Microsoft, 2026). These companies are growing quickly, especially in artificial intelligence services, although AWS still remains the market leader (CNBC, 2026) (Stocktitan, n.d.).

Other emerging competitors include platforms like Temu, which competes on low pricing, and TikTok Shop, which uses social media to attract younger customers.

Competitor	Key Segment	Threat to AMZN
Walmart	General Retail + E-Com	High (Retail)
Microsoft Azure	Cloud / AI	High (Cloud)
Google Cloud	Cloud / AI	Medium (Cloud)
Temu	Budget E-Commerce	Medium (Retail)
Alibaba	Global E-Commerce	Low (US Market)

EBAY INC. (EBAY)

Company Overview

eBay is a global online marketplace where people can buy and sell products such as electronics, fashion items, collectibles, and car parts. The company earns money through listing fees, selling fees, and payment services. eBay is mainly focusing on special product categories where it can compete strongly with larger e-commerce platforms. The company also returns money to shareholders through dividends and share buybacks (Strnad, 2026).

Price Performance & Fluctuation Analysis

During April 2026, eBay's share price increased by about 14.5%. The stock price moved from around \$91–\$93 at the beginning of April to above \$107 in the middle of the month before ending at about \$103.48 on April 30 (Yahoo, n.d.).



Reasons for the Price Changes

Early April Price Drop

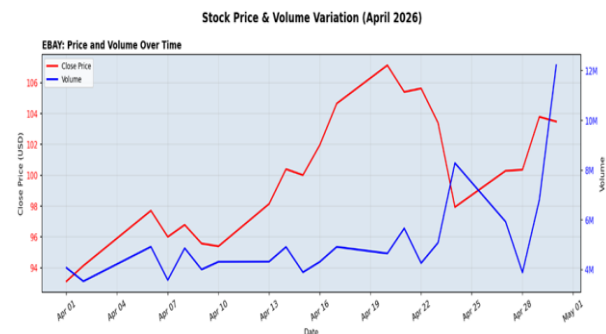
At the beginning of April, eBay's stock price dropped because of changes to the “de minimis” tariff rule. This rule previously

allowed low-value imported products to avoid certain taxes. The removal of this benefit created problems for companies involved in cross-border shipping, which negatively affected eBay's stock price .

Mid-to-Late April Price Increase

The stock price later recovered strongly due to several positive factors:

- Investors expected strong earnings results, which increased buying interest before the earnings announcement (Yahoo, n.d.).
- eBay reported better-than-expected Q1 2026 earnings. The company announced earnings per share (EPS) of \$1.66 compared to the expected \$1.58. Revenue also increased by 17% year-over-year to \$3.09 billion (Investing.com, n.d.).
- eBay's planned acquisition of Depop from Etsy increased expectations for future growth in the fashion resale market (Zikanalytics, n.d.).
- Growth in the collectibles category, especially due to the 30th anniversary of Pokémon and strong demand for sports trading cards, also boosted sales performance.



The price-volume chart shows that trading volume also increased significantly before and after the earnings announcement, showing strong interest from institutional investors.

Five-Year Historical Context



Over the last five years, eBay's stock has experienced major changes. The share price fell from around \$80 in 2021 to below \$40 in 2023 because of slowing e-commerce growth after the pandemic. However, from 2024 onward, the company recovered strongly due to its focus-category strategy, AI-powered selling tools, and share buyback programs. By April 2026, the stock price had risen above \$107, reaching a new high (Yahoo Finance, n.d.).

LSTM Forecast — May 1–14, 2026



The LSTM forecasting model predicts that eBay's stock price may decline significantly in early May 2026. The forecast shows the stock falling from about \$97.94 on May 1 to around \$84.87 by May 14. This represents a predicted decline of approximately 13.4%.

Investment Recommendation

Recommendation: SELL

The LSTM model suggests a SELL recommendation for eBay because the stock is expected to decline by about 13.4% in May 2026. Although the company reported strong financial results, the stock price has already increased significantly and is trading near record highs (Investing.com, n.d.).

There are also several risks that could negatively affect the stock price:

- Tariff-related economic issues and weaker consumer spending may reduce future sales growth.
- The Depop acquisition may reduce short-term profits and has been delayed because of regulatory reviews.
- Analysts expect the company's future earnings growth to slow down.

Because of these risks, investors may consider reducing their investment at current price levels around \$103. The forecast suggests that prices between \$85–\$88 may provide a better opportunity to buy again later.

Competitor Analysis

Amazon is eBay's biggest competitor in the e-commerce industry and holds a much larger share of the market. However, eBay mainly

focuses on second-hand goods, collectibles, and auction-style selling, which makes it different from Amazon’s standard online shopping model (*Demandsage*, n.d.).

In the second-hand fashion market, eBay competes with companies such as Poshmark, ThredUp, Vinted, and Vestiaire Collective. The planned Depop acquisition could help eBay attract more younger customers interested in fashion resale (*Valueaddedresource*, n.d.).

Low-cost platforms such as Temu and TikTok Shop also create competition, especially for low-priced products (*Marketplace Pulse*, 2026).

Competitor	Segment	Threat Level
Amazon	General E-Commerce	High
Poshmark / ThredUp	Recommerce Fashion	Medium
Vinted	European Recommerce	Medium-High
Temu / TikTok Shop	Budget / Social Commerce	Medium
Whatnot	Collectibles Live Auction	Medium

Etsy, Inc. (ETSY)

Company Overview

Etsy is an online marketplace where people can buy and sell handmade, vintage, and custom-made products. The platform has around 86.6 million buyers and supports independent sellers around the world. Etsy earns money through listing fees, transaction fees, advertising fees, and payment processing fees (*Yahoo Finance*, n.d.).

The company has recently sold some of its businesses, including Reverb, and agreed to sell Depop to eBay for \$1.2 billion. Etsy is now mainly focusing on improving its main marketplace business (*Valueaddedresource*, n.d.).

Price Performance & Fluctuation Analysis

Etsy’s stock price performed strongly in April 2026. The share price started the month near \$50, which was one of its lowest prices in recent years. Later, the stock increased sharply and reached nearly \$69 on April 29 before closing the month at around \$64.57. On April 29, the stock price increased by about 10% in one day, making it the largest one-day gain among the stocks reviewed (*Yahoo Finance*, n.d.) (*Proactiveinvestors*, n.d.) .



Reasons for the Price Changes

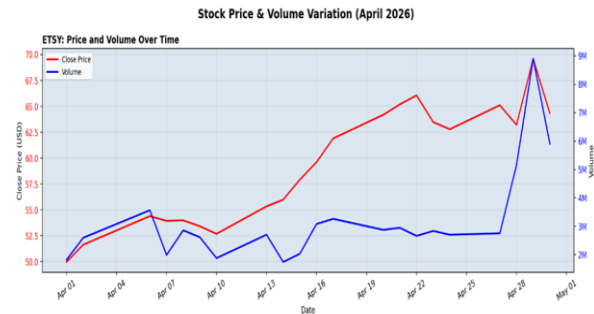
Early April Price Drop

At the beginning of April, Etsy's stock price fell because the US government removed the tax-free import rule for products under \$800. This increased costs for many Etsy sellers who import materials from other countries, leading to concerns about higher business expenses (Khusuma, 2026).

Mid-to-Late April Price Increase

The stock price later recovered because of several positive developments:

- Etsy reported stronger-than-expected Q1 2026 financial results. Revenue reached \$631.3 million, while earnings per share (EPS) were \$0.89 compared to the expected \$0.62 (Yahoo, n.d.).
- The number of active buyers increased compared to the previous quarter for the first time in two years, which showed improvement in customer activity (Motley Fool, n.d.).
- After selling Depop and Reverb, Etsy had \$1.6 billion in cash and used part of this money to buy back company shares (Motley Fool, n.d.).
- Around 90% of Etsy sellers use materials sourced within the United States, meaning the company was less affected by import taxes compared to companies like Amazon and eBay (Yahoo, n.d.).



Trading volume also increased significantly on April 29 after the earnings announcement, showing strong investor interest in the company.

Five-Year Historical Context



Over the past five years, Etsy's stock price has experienced major ups and downs. During the COVID-19 pandemic in 2021, the stock price increased from around \$160 to nearly \$300 because online shopping for handmade and custom products became very popular.

However, from 2022 to 2024, the stock price dropped below \$50 as online shopping growth slowed and sales performance weakened. The recent recovery to around \$65 may suggest that the company is improving again, although the stock price is still far below its 2021 peak (Yahoo Finance, n.d.)

LSTM Forecast — May 1–14, 2026



The LSTM forecasting model predicts that Etsy's stock price may decline slightly during May 1–14, 2026. The forecast shows the stock price falling from about \$64.57 to around \$61.65, which is a decline of approximately 4.5%. This is the smallest predicted drop among the three stocks analyzed.

Investment Recommendation

Recommendation: SELL

The AI forecasting model recommends SELL for Etsy during May 1–14, 2026. Although the predicted decline of 4.5% is smaller than the other stocks analyzed, there are still several risks that could reduce the stock price.

Etsy recently showed strong business performance. Buyer activity improved, earnings were higher than expected, and the company's financial position became stronger after selling some of its businesses (*Yahoo*, n.d.) (*Motley Fool*, n.d.).

However, the stock price has already increased by more than 30% from its April low, which may encourage short-term investors to sell and take profits. In addition, Etsy still has fewer active buyers compared

to the previous year, and competition from low-cost platforms remains strong.

The sale of Depop has also been delayed because of regulatory reviews in the UK and Australia, creating uncertainty about when Etsy will receive the expected \$1.2 billion payment. Economic uncertainty and weaker consumer spending on non-essential products may also negatively affect Etsy's future sales growth.

Although Etsy may have good long-term potential, the stock price currently appears to have increased too quickly. A lower price below \$62 may provide a better buying opportunity for investors in the future.

Competitor Analysis

Amazon Handmade is one of Etsy's biggest competitors in the handmade products market. It benefits from Amazon's large customer base and fast delivery system, although it has struggled to build the same community-focused experience that Etsy offers (*Aura*, 2026).

eBay is also a strong competitor in vintage products and resale fashion, especially after its planned acquisition of Depop (*Zikanalytics*, n.d.).

Budget-focused platforms such as Temu, Shein, and TikTok Shop compete with Etsy by offering cheaper products, especially in gifts and fashion items (*Aura*, 2026).

Other smaller competitors include Bonanza, Mercari, and Redbubble.

Competitor	Segment	Threat Level	Key Differentiator
Amazon Handmade	Handmade Goods	High	Scale, Prime, Fulfilment
eBay (+ Depop)	Vintage / Recommerce Fashion	Medium-High	Broader Inventory
Temu / Shein	Budget Personalised Goods	Medium	Price (but tariff-hit)
Bonanza / Mercari	Handmade / Resale	Low-Medium	Lower Fees
Redbubble	Print-on-Demand Art	Low	Artist-Focused

Consolidated Forecast section

The table below presents the complete LSTM model output for all three covered stocks across the forecast window. Signals are derived from the direction and magnitude of the predicted price trajectory relative to the April 30 closing price.

Date	AMZN Pred. Close	EBAY Pred. Close	ETSY Pred. Close	Signals
May 01	\$259.25	\$97.94	\$64.57	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 04	\$257.53	\$94.35	\$64.46	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 05	\$255.48	\$92.45	\$64.17	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 06	\$253.38	\$91.08	\$63.81	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 07	\$251.45	\$89.87	\$63.43	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 08	\$249.73	\$88.74	\$63.05	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 11	\$248.18	\$87.69	\$62.67	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 12	\$246.76	\$86.70	\$62.32	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 13	\$245.43	\$85.76	\$61.98	SELL / SELL / SELL
May 14	\$244.16	\$84.87	\$61.65	SELL / SELL / SELL

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